03_Leave_and_Attendance_Policy

Meridian Global Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

Document classification: Internal — HR Access Only **Applies to:** All full-time and contract employees **Last reviewed:** January 2026 | **Owner:** People & Culture Team

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1. Purpose

This policy defines the types of leave available to employees, the process for requesting leave, and attendance expectations. It is designed to give employees flexibility while ensuring adequate team coverage and predictable planning for managers.

2. Leave Types

Leave Type	Annual Entitlement	Carry Forward	Encashable
Casual Leave	12 days	No	No
Sick Leave	10 days	Up to 5 days	No
Earned/Privilege Leave	18 days	Up to 30 days	Yes, on exit
Maternity Leave	26 weeks	Not applicable	No
Paternity Leave	15 days	Not applicable	No
Bereavement Leave	5 days per event	Not applicable	No
Unpaid Leave	As approved	Not applicable	No

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Leave entitlement is pro-rated for employees joining mid-year, based on the number of complete months of service in that calendar year.

3. Leave Accrual and Carry Forward

Casual and Sick Leave are credited at the start of each calendar year. Earned Leave accrues monthly at 1.5 days per completed month of service. Unused Earned Leave beyond the carry-forward cap of 30 days is automatically lapsed at year-end unless the employee has an approved exception on file with HR.

4. Application Process

All leave (except emergency sick leave) must be applied for through the HR portal at least 2 working days in advance. Emergency sick leave may be applied for retroactively but must be logged within 2 working days of return to work, along with a medical certificate for absences exceeding 3 consecutive days.

Leave requests are routed automatically to the employee’s reporting manager for approval. Managers are expected to respond within 2 working days; unactioned requests beyond 3 working days are auto-escalated to the manager’s manager.

5. Approval Workflow

1. Employee submits leave request via HR portal, specifying dates and leave type.
2. Manager reviews for team coverage and approves or rejects with a stated reason.
3. Approved leave is reflected in the employee’s leave balance and shared calendar.

4. For leave exceeding 10 consecutive working days, HR Business Partner sign-off is also required.

6. Attendance and Biometric Rules

Employees working from office locations must log attendance via biometric check-in/check-out. Employees in hybrid or remote arrangements log attendance via the HR portal. Attendance records are used solely for payroll processing and workforce planning, and are treated as confidential HR data.

Repeated attendance irregularities (more than 3 unexplained absences in a rolling 30-day period) trigger an automatic review conversation between the employee, manager, and HR Business Partner.

7. Public Holidays

The Company observes 10 public holidays annually, published on the HR portal at the start of each calendar year based on the employee’s work location. Employees required to work on a public holiday due to business need are entitled to a compensatory day off, to be availed within 30 days.

8. Work From Home Policy

Employees in hybrid roles may work from home up to 2 days per week without prior approval, subject to team coverage norms set by their manager. Fully remote arrangements require a separate written agreement between the employee, manager, and HR, reviewed annually.

Employees working from home are expected to be reachable during core collaboration hours (11:00 AM - 4:00 PM) as defined in the Employee Handbook.

9. Leave Encashment

Earned Leave balance up to the carry-forward cap may be encashed once per year during the designated encashment window (typically March), at the employee’s current basic salary rate. Full Earned Leave balance is encashed as part of full and final settlement upon exit, regardless of the annual window.

10. Special Circumstances

Maternity Leave: Available to employees who have completed at least 80 days of service in the 12 months preceding the expected delivery date, in accordance with applicable statutory requirements. Extension beyond the statutory period may be granted as unpaid leave upon request.

Paternity Leave: Available to male employees for the birth or adoption of a child, to be availed within 6 months of the event.

Sabbatical: Employees with 3+ years of continuous service may apply for an unpaid sabbatical of up to 6 months, subject to Department Head and HR Head approval, for personal development, further education, or family care needs.

11. Contact

Questions regarding leave balances, policy exceptions, or attendance discrepancies should be directed to the HR portal helpdesk or the employee’s assigned HR Business Partner.